

The Language of the Year 2009



In the exciting world of programming languages, which one ought to bag the 'Language of the Year 2009' award? In this article, we pick a winner!

As I write this article, the headlines in today's newspaper are about the release of Volkswagen's Polo in India. And here is something interesting about Polo: it won the 'Car of the Year' award [www.caroftheyear.org/] in Europe this year. There are thousands of car models in the world and hundreds of new car models released every year. An award like this separates the best car from the rest. So if you're interested in buying a new premium hatchback, it goes without saying that you should consider Polo first—if it has won an award beating all other new models, it's got to be good.

In a way, the programming language space is similar

to cars. There are thousands of programming languages. Yes, believe me, it's true. For example, <http://people.ka.edu/~nkinners/LangList/Extras/langlist.htm> lists around 2,500 languages with numerous new ones released every year. Recent languages that received wide attention are Scala, D, and GO. So if you want to learn a new language, which one would you consider? While developing a killer application, which language would you choose for it? And what language would you pick on to improve your chances of getting a job?

In other words, wouldn't it be interesting to select the *Language of the Year*? Yes, this article is about exactly that. Let's first go through a general introduction to languages—